shall soon have to bear the consequences. Moreover, has the IDF forgotten the slogan it was proud of: “the purity of arms”? It may belong to a world without Hamas, but Israel has to fight Hamas, without in any way being infected by its brutality and its total lack of humaneness.

According to US sources, a rocket fired by Hamas at the outset of the war hit a military base where Israel keeps some of its nuclear missiles. A fire started at the base but did not reach the missiles. In any case, the warheads are kept somewhere else. Also according to US sources, Israel has installed five pumps capable of filling the Hamas tunnels with thousands of gallons of seawater, which would compel its fighters to abandon their underground hideouts but would also threaten the water supply of the Gaza population. According to the same sources, Israel has not yet decided to activate the pumps.

Hamas keeps ten women hostages, who according to Israel are alive. If Hamas agrees to liberate these women, Israel will be ready for another pause in the fighting to discuss all other categories of hostages (older men, wounded ones, men of military service age, etc.) to be released in exchange for Palestinians kept in Israeli prisons.

Tuesday, December 5

Today, the US decided not to grant visas to settlers convicted of violence against Palestinians. Although quite a few are Americans, this certainly won’t deter them.

This morning in Israel, a very painful meeting took place between women who are released hostages and the war cabinet. The women are afraid that measures taken by the IDF to neutralize the tunnels will result in the killing of their loved ones, who are held in those tunnels. Netanyahu, instead of talking to them in a compassionate way, as their situation demanded, read them a declaration prepared ahead of time.